

Iris Yan

UX Researcher | Data-Informed Product Research

I turn ambiguous product questions into research questions, choose appropriate methods, uncover behavioral patterns, and translate evidence into decisions that product teams can act on.

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PROJECTS

Amtrak First-Time Rider Experience | Product Lead & User Researcher Mar 2025 – May 2025, Philadelphia

Led mixed-method research to understand friction in first-time riders' end-to-end travel journeys and identify opportunities to improve confidence and wayfinding.

- Planned and conducted iterative user research, synthesizing behavioral patterns and unmet needs across the pre-trip, station, and boarding experience.
- Translated findings into prioritized opportunity areas and product requirements; partnered with the team to validate concepts through iterative testing.
- Communicated research findings and recommendations to Amtrak stakeholders, contributing to partial adoption into Amtrak's 2025 product update.

Spotify Cold-Start Discovery | Quantitative Product Researcher + Independent Designer Mar 2025 - June 2025, Philadelphia

Investigated why newly released Spotify tracks fail to gain exposure, combining large-scale behavioral data analysis with product opportunity framing.

- Analyzed 114K Spotify tracks through EDA, feature engineering, and predictive modeling to investigate factors associated with track popularity and cold-start discovery.
- Tested multiple model classes; improved predictive performance to $R^2 = 0.51$ with a tuned Random Forest.
- Translated quantitative findings into a product hypothesis for proactively surfacing high-potential, zero-play-history tracks to editorial curators.

Horizons, an AI Powered Extension for International Students | Product Lead, Won 1st place in Wharton x JP Morgan Chase Design Challenge Apr 2025, Philadelphia & New York

Led a team of 4 through a fast-paced, 4-day design challenge, presented the final concept at JP Morgan Chase HQ; recognized by Chase's CPO and product, design, and data teams.

- Researched how international students assess U.S. career opportunities, uncovering key barriers around visa eligibility and fragmented information.
- Synthesized findings into a personalized job-evaluation concept and product strategy, winning 1st place in the Wharton x J.P. Morgan Chase Design Challenge.

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant | International Design Institute, Zhejiang University Jun 2023 – Dec 2023, Zhejiang, China

Conducted HCI research, contributing to a peer-reviewed ACM CHI 2024 publication recognized with a Best Paper Honorable Mention.

- Conducted literature review and developed research protocols/materials for smart textiles.
- Led usability test and user interviews, including participant research and data collection.
- Analyzed qualitative/quantitative findings and synthesized results into research conclusions and design implications.
- Co-authored research publication and supported research documentation and dissemination.

Product Manager Intern | NIO Oct 2022 – Jan 2023, Shanghai, China

- Analyzed 10K+ records across 10+ vehicle models to identify systemic workflow and data-quality failures during a global procurement-system migration.
- Investigated recurring exception patterns and traced root causes across user workflows, system dependencies, and data structures.
- Synthesized findings into workflow and interface recommendations that improved operational efficiency for internal procurement teams.

UX Designer Intern | Meituan Jun 2022 – Oct 2022, Beijing, China

- Investigated usability issues across internal front-end development and delivery workflows through stakeholder interviews, workflow analysis, and iterative testing.
- Identified friction in engineering-production handoffs and translated findings into revised workflows and interaction recommendations.
- Designed and evaluated onboarding guidance for an internal design tool, improving discoverability and reducing learning friction.

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

Master in Integrated Product Design (STEM)

2024/8 - 2026/5
GPA: 3.92/4.00

Zhejiang University (top 3 university in China)

Bachelor in Product Design

2019/9 - 2024/6
GPA: 3.87/4.00

RESEARCH SKILLS

Qualitative Research

- User Interviews
- Contextual Inquiry
- Usability Testing
- Concept Testing
- Diary Studies
- Observation
- Stakeholder Interviews

Research Synthesis

- Thematic Analysis
- Affinity Mapping
- Journey Mapping
- Behavioral Segmentation
- Insight Synthesis
- Research Reporting

Quantitative Research & Analytics

- Survey Design
- Statistical Analysis
- A/B Testing
- Regression
- Clustering

Research Operations / Tools

- Figma, FigJam
- Excel
- Python
- SQL
- Pandas
- NumPy

Product & Prototyping

- Wireframing
- Interactive Prototyping
- Information Architecture
- AI-Assisted Prototyping

AI Research Workflows

- AI-assisted synthesis
- Research analysis
- Rapid prototyping